



1. India - as a founding member

United Nations (UN)

- Established: 24 October 1945 (UN Day)
- Original members: 51 countries
- Present membership: 193 Member States
- It was among the original signatories of the UN Charter in 1945, before independence.
- HQ: New York City, United States
- Official languages:** Arabic, Chinese, English, French, Russian and Spanish
- The Secretary General of the United Nations is appointed for 5 years.
- Vijaya Lakshmi Pandit** was the **first woman in the world to be elected President of the United Nations General Assembly (UNGA)**. She was India's chief delegate and was elected in **1953** to preside over the **8th session of the UN General Assembly (1953-54)**.
- Six principal organs:

Organ	Composition / location
General Assembly (UNGA)	All 193 Member States; each has one vote
Security Council (UNSC)	15 members: 5 permanent and 10 elected
Economic and Social Council (ECOSOC)	54 members elected by the General Assembly
International Court of Justice (ICJ)	The Hague, Netherlands
Secretariat	Headed by the Secretary-General
Trusteeship Council	Suspended operations in 1994

- United Nations Security Council (UNSC):
 - Five permanent members (P5): China, France, Russia, the United Kingdom and the United States.
 - Ten non-permanent members: Elected by the General Assembly for two-year terms.
- The UN is more than its six principal organs. The wider UN system includes specialised agencies, funds, programmes, treaty bodies and related organizations.
- United Nations and specialized agencies:

Organization	Established	Headquarters
United Nations (UN)	1945	New York City, United States
International Labour Organization (ILO)	1919	Geneva, Switzerland
International Monetary Fund (IMF)	1944	Washington, D.C., United States
International Bank for Reconstruction and Development (IBRD / World Bank)	1944	Washington, D.C., United States
International Finance Corporation (IFC)	1956	Washington, D.C., United States
International Development Association (IDA)	1960	Washington, D.C., United States
Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations (FAO)	1945	Rome, Italy
United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization (UNESCO)	1945	Paris, France
World Health Organization (WHO)	1948	Geneva, Switzerland
International Civil Aviation Organization (ICAO)	1944	Montreal, Canada
International Telecommunication Union (ITU)	1865	Geneva, Switzerland
Universal Postal Union (UPU)	1874	Bern, Switzerland
World Meteorological Organization (WMO)	1950	Geneva, Switzerland
International Maritime Organization (IMO)	1948	London, United Kingdom

World Intellectual Property Organization (WIPO)	1967	Geneva, Switzerland
International Atomic Energy Agency (IAEA)	1957	Vienna, Austria
United Nations Children's Fund (UNICEF)	1946	New York City, United States
United Nations Development Programme (UNDP)	1965	New York City, United States
Office of the United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees (UNHCR)	1950	Geneva, Switzerland
United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP)	1972	Nairobi, Kenya
World Food Programme (WFP)	1961	Rome, Italy
UN Women	2010	New York City, United States

Q. Consider the following UN organisations/agencies : [IAS 2026]

1. World Food Programme
2. United Nations Children's Fund
3. United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees
4. International Labour Organisation

How many of the above has/have been awarded the Nobel Prize twice?

- (a) 1
- (b) 2
- (c) 3
- (d) 4

Trade, development and legal institutions

Organization	Established / key dates	Headquarters	Core mandate and important details
General Agreement on Tariffs and Trade (GATT)	Signed on 30 October 1947 ; provisionally applied from 1 January 1948 ; largely superseded institutionally by the WTO in 1995	Secretariat based in Geneva, Switzerland	GATT was a multilateral agreement , not a formal international organization. It governed trade in goods , aiming to reduce tariffs and other trade barriers. GATT 1947 is no longer separately operative; GATT 1994 continues as part of the WTO framework for trade in goods.
World Trade Organization (WTO)	Established on 1 January 1995 under the Marrakesh Agreement , signed on 15 April 1994	Geneva, Switzerland	Permanent international organization for multilateral trade. It covers goods through GATT 1994, services through GATS, and



			intellectual property through TRIPS. It administers trade agreements, provides a negotiation forum, reviews trade policies and manages the dispute-settlement framework.
Asian Development Bank (ADB)	Established in 1966 ; Agreement entered into force on 22 August 1966	Manila, Philippines	Regional multilateral development bank for Asia-Pacific. It finances infrastructure, social development, climate resilience, poverty reduction, regional cooperation and private-sector development through loans, grants, guarantees, equity investments and technical assistance.
Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank (AIIB)	Articles of Agreement signed on 29 June 2015 ; entered into force on 25 December 2015 ; operations commenced on 16 January 2016	Beijing, China	Multilateral development bank focused on sustainable infrastructure and connectivity. Key sectors include transport, energy, water, urban development, digital infrastructure and climate-related investment. Its Articles of Agreement designate Beijing as its principal office.
New Development Bank (NDB)	Established through the Agreement signed at Fortaleza, Brazil, on 15 July 2014 ; began operations in 2015	Shanghai, China	Created by BRICS countries to mobilise resources for infrastructure and sustainable-development projects in BRICS and other emerging-market and developing economies. It was initially described as the BRICS Development Bank .
International Development Association (IDA)	Established in 1960	Washington, D.C., United States	A World Bank Group institution who provides concessional financing—credits and grants—to the world's poorest countries for poverty reduction and development.

Regional and plurilateral groupings

Organization / grouping	Established	India's position	Headquarters / secretariat
Commonwealth of Nations	Modern arrangement: 1949	Founding participant in the republican Commonwealth framework under the London Declaration	London, United Kingdom
Non-Aligned Movement (NAM)	1961	Founding member and principal architect	No permanent headquarters
South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation (SAARC)	1985	Founding member	Kathmandu, Nepal
Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation (BIMSTEC)	1997	Founding member	Dhaka, Bangladesh
Indian Ocean Rim Association (IORA)	1997	Founding member	Ebene, Mauritius



ASEAN Regional Forum (ARF)	1994	Founding participant/member; not an ASEAN member	Jakarta, Indonesia
BRICS	2006	Founding member with Brazil, Russia and China; South Africa joined in 2010	No single permanent secretariat
IBSA Dialogue Forum	2003	Founding member with Brazil and South Africa	No permanent secretariat

→ South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation (SAARC)

- It was established through the SAARC Charter, adopted at the first SAARC Summit in Dhaka, Bangladesh, on 8 December 1985.
- Secretariat: Kathmandu, Nepal
- Founding members: Bangladesh, Bhutan, India, Maldives, Nepal, Pakistan and Sri Lanka
- Eighth member: Afghanistan, admitted in April 2007
- Working language: English

→ Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation (BIMSTEC)

- It is a regional organization linking **South Asia and Southeast Asia** through the Bay of Bengal.
- It was launched through the **Bangkok Declaration on 6 June 1997** and has seven member states.
- HQ: Dhaka, Bangladesh
- BIMSTEC includes **five South Asian** (Bangladesh, Bhutan, India, Nepal, Sri Lanka) and **two Southeast Asian** (Myanmar and Thailand) countries.
- BIMSTEC initially began as **BIST-EC**. Myanmar joined in December 1997, and Bhutan and Nepal joined in February 2004; the group subsequently adopted its present BIMSTEC identity.

Summit	Year	Host city / country
1st	2004	Bangkok, Thailand
2nd	2008	New Delhi, India
3rd (decision to establish the Secretariat)	2014	Nay Pyi Taw, Myanmar
4th	2018	Kathmandu, Nepal
5th	2022	Colombo, Sri Lanka — held in hybrid/virtual mode
6th	2025	Bangkok, Thailand

At the Fifth BIMSTEC Summit in Colombo on **30 March 2022**, the earlier 14-sector arrangement was rationalised into **seven pillars**, with one member state designated as lead country for each pillar.

Priority pillar	Lead member state
Trade, Investment and Development	Bangladesh
Environment and Climate Change	Bhutan
Security (Counter-Terrorism and Transnational Crime; Disaster Management; Energy)	India
Agriculture and Food Security	Myanmar
People-to-People Contact	Nepal
Science, Technology and Innovation	Sri Lanka
Connectivity	Thailand

- The **BIMSTEC Energy Centre (BEC)** is located in **Bengaluru, India**



→ Indian Ocean Rim Association (IORA)

- It was formally established on **7 March 1997** in Port Louis, Mauritius, and currently includes **23 Member States** and **12 Dialogue Partners**.
- Earlier name: Indian Ocean Rim Association for Regional Cooperation (**IOR-ARC**)
- Headquarters / Secretariat: Ebene, Mauritius

Region	Members
Africa / western Indian Ocean	Comoros, France, Kenya, Madagascar, Mauritius, Mozambique, Seychelles, Somalia, South Africa, Tanzania
West Asia / Indian Ocean islands	Iran, Maldives, Oman, United Arab Emirates, Yemen
South and Southeast Asia	Bangladesh, India, Indonesia, Malaysia, Singapore, Sri Lanka, Thailand
Oceania	Australia

- France is a Member State through Reunion, its Indian Ocean overseas department.
- India and IORA:
 - India is a founding member of IORA.
 - IORA aligns with India's SAGAR vision—Security and Growth for All in the Region—and its broader Indian Ocean and Indo-Pacific approach.
 - India hosted the first IORA Tourism Ministers' Meeting in 2014 and has actively promoted cooperation on maritime safety, blue economy, disaster resilience and connectivity.
 - India chaired IORA from 2011 to 2013.
 - India hosted the IORA Council of Ministers' Meeting in 2021, held virtually.

→ BRICS

- It is a political and diplomatic coordination forum of major emerging and developing economies, intended to strengthen cooperation among Global South countries and advocate reforms in global governance.
- It began as **BRIC**—Brazil, Russia, India and China—and became **BRICS** when South Africa joined in 2011. It now has **11 full members** and **10 partner countries**.
- Origin of term: Coined as **BRIC** by economist Jim O'Neill in 2001
- First BRIC Summit: Yekaterinburg, Russia, 2009
- South Africa joined: 2011, at the Sanya Summit in China
- No permanent headquarters or secretariat
- Chairmanship: Rotates annually among members
- Main institutional mechanisms: Annual summit, ministerial meetings, New Development Bank and Contingent Reserve Arrangement. The NDB and CRA were agreed at the **6th BRICS Summit in Fortaleza, Brazil, on 15 July 2014**.
- The grouping's 11 members are Brazil, Russia, India, China, South Africa, Saudi Arabia, Egypt, the United Arab Emirates, Ethiopia, Indonesia and Iran. Egypt, Ethiopia, Iran, Saudi Arabia and the UAE joined during the 2024 expansion, while Indonesia became a member in January 2025.
- BRICS Partner Countries: Belarus, Bolivia, Cuba, Kazakhstan, Malaysia, Nigeria, Thailand, Uganda, Uzbekistan & Vietnam
 - The partner-country category was established at the 2024 Kazan Summit.
 - Belarus, Bolivia, Cuba, Kazakhstan, Malaysia, Thailand, Uganda and Uzbekistan became partners from 1 January 2025; Nigeria subsequently accepted the invitation, and Vietnam was formally admitted in June 2025.

BRICS Summits
• 18th BRICS Summit: 2026 (New Delhi, India) • 17th BRICS Summit: 2025 (Rio de Janeiro) • 16th BRICS Summit: 2024 (Kazan, Russia) • 15th BRICS Summit: 2023 (Johannesburg; South Africa) • 14th BRICS Summit: 2022 (Beijing)



- **13th BRICS Summit: 2021 (New Delhi)**
- 12th BRICS Summit: 2020 (Moscow)
- 11th BRICS Summit: 2019 (Brasilia)
- 10th BRICS Summit: 2018 (Johannesburg)
- 9th BRICS Summit: 2017 (Xiamen)
- **8th BRICS Summit: 2016 (Goa)**
- 7th BRICS Summit: 2015 Russia (Ufa)
- **6th BRICS Summit: 2014 (Fortaleza, Brazil)**
- 5th BRICS Summit: 2013 in South Africa (Durban)
- **4th BRICS Summit: 2012 in India (New Delhi)**
- 3rd BRICS Summit: 2011 in China (Sanya)
- 2nd BRIC Summit: 2010 in Brazil (Brasilia)
- **1st BRIC Summit: 2009 in Russia (Yekaterinburg)**

2. India: member, not founding member

Political, regional and strategic forums

Organization / grouping	India's status	Important point
Group of Twenty (G20)	Member	India is a member but should not normally be described as a treaty "founding member"
Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO)	Full member since 2017	India was an observer before joining as a full member
East Asia Summit (EAS)	Member	India joined as one of the original EAS participants in 2005; EAS is not an organization with a conventional treaty-based membership structure
I2U2 → 2021 (Abraham Acc.)	Member	India, Israel, UAE and United States cooperation grouping
Quad 2022 - 1st official virtual meeting	Member	India, Australia, Japan and the United States; an informal strategic grouping, not a formal international organization

→ Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO)

- It is a Eurasian intergovernmental organization focused on regional security, counter-terrorism, political coordination, economic cooperation and cultural ties.
- It was established in **Shanghai, China, on 15 June 2001** by six states and today has **10 full members**.
- **Founding members:** China, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan, Russia, Tajikistan and Uzbekistan
- The SCO has two permanent bodies: the **SCO Secretariat in Beijing** and the Executive Committee of the **Regional Anti-Terrorist Structure (RATS)** in Tashkent.
- Official languages: Chinese and Russian
- The Secretary General is appointed for 3 years.
- **Evolution**

Milestone	Year	Significance
Shanghai Five formed	1996	China, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan, Russia and Tajikistan began border-security confidence-building consultations
SCO established	2001	Uzbekistan joined the Shanghai Five states, creating the SCO
SCO Charter	2002	Set out institutional structure, objectives and principles
India and Pakistan join (Astana Summit)	2017	Membership expanded from 6 to 8
Iran joins	2023	Became the 9th full member
Belarus joins	2024	Became the 10th full member



Proposed institutional-status reform	2025	SCO leaders approved creation of a unified “SCO Partner” status, intended ultimately to replace separate observer and <u>dialogue-partner</u> categories; pending treaty amendments, existing statuses remain in force.
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- Full members (10): Belarus, China, India, Iran, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan, Pakistan, Russia, Tajikistan, and Uzbekistan.

2025 :- Tianjin, China

2026 :- Bishkek

→ QUAD

- The **Quad**, formally the **Quadrilateral Security Dialogue**, is a diplomatic partnership among **Australia, India, Japan and the United States**.
- It promotes a free, open, stable, inclusive, prosperous and resilient Indo-Pacific through practical cooperation; it is **not a military alliance** and has no treaty, permanent secretariat or headquarters.
- First officials’ meeting: May 2007, on the margins of the ASEAN Regional Forum in Manila, Philippines
- The sixth Quad Leaders’ Summit was held in **Wilmington, Delaware, on 21 September 2024**.
- The 10th Quad Foreign Ministers’ Meeting took place in **Washington, D.C., on 1 July 2025**. The ministers announced the **Quad Critical Minerals Initiative**, aimed at securing and diversifying critical-mineral supply chains.

→ Group of Twenty (G20)

- The Group of Twenty (G20) is the premier informal forum for international economic cooperation among major advanced and emerging economies.
- It was formed in 1999, initially as a meeting of finance ministers and central-bank governors after the Asian financial crisis; following the 2008 global financial crisis, it became a leaders’ summit-level forum.
- Total members : 21 (19 countries plus the European Union and African Union)
- The G20 comprises 19 countries: Argentina, Australia, Brazil, Canada, China, France, Germany, India, Indonesia, Italy, Japan, Mexico, Republic of Korea (South Korea), Russia, Saudi Arabia, South Africa, Türkiye, the United Kingdom and the United States. The two regional members are:
 - European Union (EU)
 - African Union (AU) — admitted as a permanent member during India’s G20 Presidency in 2023.
- 2026 Presidency: United States
- The G20 has **no permanent secretariat** and no legally binding charter.
- The G20 summit holds annually.
- India held the G20 Presidency from 1 December 2022 to 30 November 2023. Its theme was “Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam — One Earth, One Family, One Future.”
 - Launch of the **Global Biofuels Alliance** on the sidelines of the New Delhi Summit.
- Troika system**: Because a single-year presidency could disrupt continuity, the G20 uses a Troika—a three-country coordination arrangement comprising:
 - The immediate past presidency
 - The current presidency
 - The incoming next presidency

Role	Country
Previous presidency	Brazil (2024)
Current presidency	South Africa (2025)
Next presidency	United States (2026)

Finance, trade, law and security

Organization	Established	Headquarters / Secretariat
International Criminal Police Organization (INTERPOL)	1923	General Secretariat: Lyon, France
Financial Action Task Force (FATF)	1989	Paris, France
Wassenaar Arrangement (WA)	1996	Secretariat: Vienna, Austria



Nuclear Suppliers Group (NSG)	1975	No permanent headquarters; the NSG's support functions and plenary meetings are associated with Vienna, Austria
International Criminal Court (ICC)	1998 (Rome Statute adopted); operational from 2002	The Hague, Netherlands

→ North Atlantic Treaty Organization (NATO)

- The **North Atlantic Treaty Organization (NATO)** is a collective-defence political and military alliance of **32 European and North American countries**.
- It was created by the **North Atlantic Treaty (Washington Treaty)**, signed in Washington, D.C., on **4 April 1949**.
- NATO was founded by 12 countries in 1949. Its central commitment, Article 5, treats an armed attack against one or more Allies in Europe or North America as an attack against all and requires each Ally to assist by taking action it considers necessary, including armed force if needed.
- Official languages: English and French
- Headquarters: **Brussels, Belgium**.
- Military headquarters: **SHAPE, Mons, Belgium**.
- **NATO's 32 members are:** Albania, Belgium, Bulgaria, Canada, Croatia, Czechia, Denmark, Estonia, Finland, France, Germany, Greece, Hungary, Iceland, Italy, Latvia, Lithuania, Luxembourg, Montenegro, Netherlands, North Macedonia, Norway, Poland, Portugal, Romania, Slovakia, Slovenia, Spain, Sweden, Türkiye, the United Kingdom and the United States.
- Latest members: **Finland (2023)** and **Sweden (2024)**.

→ European Union (EU)

- The European Union (EU) is a unique economic and political union of 27 European countries. It was formally created when the Maastricht Treaty entered into force on 1 November 1993.
- Motto: "United in Diversity"
- **The 27 EU members are:** Austria, Belgium, Bulgaria, Croatia, Cyprus, Czechia, Denmark, Estonia, Finland, France, Germany, Greece, Hungary, Ireland, Italy, Latvia, Lithuania, Luxembourg, Malta, Netherlands, Poland, Portugal, Romania, Slovakia, Slovenia, Spain and Sweden.

→ Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN)

- It was established in Bangkok, Thailand, on 8 August 1967 through the ASEAN Declaration (Bangkok Declaration) and now has 11 Member States, following Timor-Leste's admission in October 2025.
- Secretariat: Jakarta, Indonesia
- Motto: "One Vision, One Identity, One Community"
- ASEAN Day: 8 August
- ASEAN member states

State	Joined ASEAN
Indonesia	1967 — Founding member
Malaysia	1967 — Founding member
Philippines	1967 — Founding member
Singapore	1967 — Founding member
Thailand	1967 — Founding member
Brunei Darussalam	1984
Vietnam	1995
Lao PDR	1997
Myanmar	1997

Cambodia	1999
Timor-Leste	2025

India-led and India-initiated platforms

Platform	Year	Nature	India's role	Headquarters / secretariat
International Solar Alliance (ISA)	2015	Treaty-based intergovernmental organization for solar-energy deployment	Co-launched with France at COP21	Gurugram, Haryana
Coalition for Disaster Resilient Infrastructure (CDRI)	2019	International coalition for resilient infrastructure	Launched by India at the UN Climate Action Summit	New Delhi
Global Biofuels Alliance (GBA)	2023	Multi-stakeholder alliance for sustainable biofuels	Launched during India's G20 Presidency	Secretariat arrangements are linked to India; do not equate it automatically with a conventional treaty organization
International Big Cat Alliance (IBCA)	2023	Intergovernmental alliance for big-cat conservation	Initiated by India	India
International North-South Transport Corridor (INSTC)	2000	Multimodal connectivity corridor	India was among the initiating founding states with Iran and Russia	No single conventional headquarters
India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor (IMEC)	2023	Connectivity initiative	India is a signatory/partner, alongside EU, US, Saudi Arabia, UAE and others	No permanent secretariat
One Sun, One World, One Grid (OSOWOG)	Announced 2018	Global renewable-energy connectivity vision	India-origin initiative, associated with ISA	Not a separate treaty-based organization
LIFE—Lifestyle for Environment	2022	Global behavioural climate-action movement	India-initiated	Not a formal international organization

→ International Big Cat Alliance (IBCA)

- It is a treaty-based, inter-governmental international organisation **headquartered in New Delhi, India**, dedicated to the conservation of the **world's seven principal big cats — the tiger, lion, leopard, snow leopard, cheetah, jaguar and puma**.
- Nodal Indian body:** National Tiger Conservation Authority, Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change
- It was **conceived by Prime Minister Narendra Modi on April 9, 2023**, in Mysuru during celebrations marking the 50th anniversary of Project Tiger.
- India established the IBCA through the National Tiger Conservation Authority, under the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change, in March 2024.
- The Union Cabinet, chaired by PM Modi, approved India's membership and the establishment of the IBCA with headquarters in India on February 29, 2024, sanctioning one-time budgetary support of Rs. 150 crore for a five-year period from 2023-24 to 2027-28.





- Project Tiger is India's flagship wildlife conservation program **launched on April 1, 1973**, at **Jim Corbett National Park** to protect the endangered Bengal tiger from extinction.
- Centrally Sponsored Scheme
- Implemented by:** Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change (MoEFCC)
- Project Tiger has established a network of 58 tiger reserves across 18 tiger-range States. These reserves cover around 84,500 square kilometres, which is about 2.56% of India's geographical area.
- The **Wild Life (Protection) Act, 1972** is India's key law for protecting wild animals, birds, plants, and related habitats, and for curbing poaching, smuggling, and illegal wildlife trade. It was enacted by Parliament on 9 September 1972.
- The **major amendment years** for the Wild Life (Protection) Act are 1982, 1986, 1991, 1993, 2002, 2006, and 2022. The Act was last amended in 2022, and that amendment came into force from 1 April 2023.

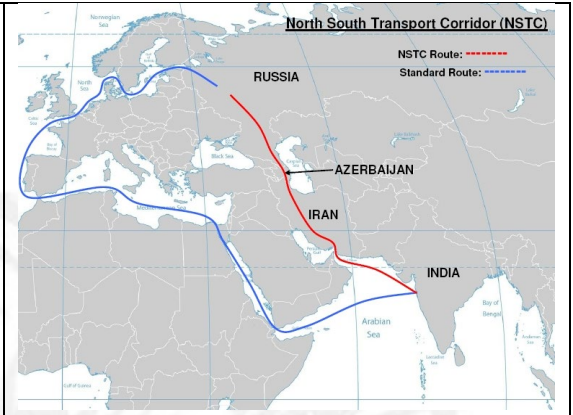
→ International Solar Alliance (ISA)

- It is a treaty-based intergovernmental organization launched by India and France at **COP21** on 30 November 2015 to promote solar energy adoption, especially in countries with strong solar potential. It is headquartered in **Gurugram, Haryana**.
- ISA's long-term strategy, called "**Towards 1000**," aims to mobilize USD 1,000 billion in solar investment by 2030, help deliver energy access to 1,000 million people, and achieve 1,000 GW of solar capacity.
- Framework Agreement opened for signature: 15 November 2016, Marrakesh, Morocco
- According to **IRENA Renewable Energy Statistics 2025**, India ranks 4th globally in Renewable Energy Installed Capacity, 4th in Wind Power, and 3rd in Solar Power capacity.

→ International North-South Transport Corridor (INSTC)

- It is a multimodal connectivity initiative linking India with Iran, the Caucasus, Central Asia, Russia and Northern Europe through sea, rail, road and inland-waterway routes. It originated in an intergovernmental agreement signed by **India, Iran and Russia** at St. Petersburg on **12 September 2000** and entered into force in **2002**.
- Approximate length: Around 7,200 km
- At present, there are 13 Members of INSTC, namely- India, Iran, Russia, Azerbaijan, Armenia, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan, Tajikistan, Turkey, Ukraine, Belarus, Oman and Syria. Bulgaria has joined as an Observer State.
- Complements India's investment in Iran's **Chabahar Port**, which supports access to Afghanistan and Central Asia; however, Chabahar is a complementary route rather than the original central INSTC alignment.
- Major routes**

Route	Broad alignment	Map
Central route	India → Bandar Abbas → Iranian Caspian ports → Astrakhan → Russia → Europe	
Western route	India → Iran → Azerbaijan → Russia → Europe	

Eastern route	India → Iran → Turkmenistan → Kazakhstan → Russia	 North-South Transport Corridor (NSTC) NSTC Route: ----- Standard Route: ----- Map labels: RUSSIA, AZERBAIJAN, IRAN, INDIA, Caspian Sea, Arabian Sea, Bay of Bengal.
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Chabahar Port

- **Chabahar Port** is a strategically located seaport in **south-eastern Iran**, on the Gulf of Oman/Indian Ocean, in Sistan–Baluchestan province.
- For India, it is important because it creates a sea-and-land route to **Afghanistan and Central Asia that bypasses Pakistan**.
- Chabahar lies on Iran's Makran coast, outside the Strait of Hormuz—an important distinction from Iran's principal port of Bandar Abbas.
- India and Iran signed a **10-year contract on 13 May 2024** for operating and developing Shahid Beheshti Terminal
- Chabahar Port enables India to send goods and humanitarian assistance to Afghanistan through Iran, bypassing Pakistan; the first such Indian **wheat consignment** was dispatched in October **2017** and moved via Chabahar–Milak–Zaranj–Delaram.

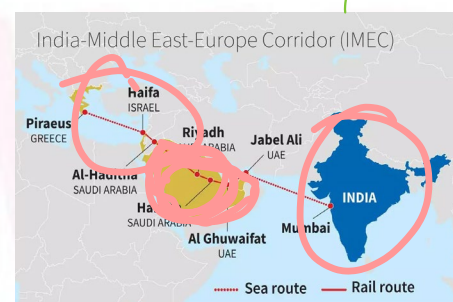


*It has two main terminals: **Shahid Beheshti** and **Shahid Kalantari**.*

→ India–Middle East–Europe Economic Corridor (IMEC)

India Ports Global Ltd. : operates

Corridor	Broad route
Eastern Corridor	India ↔ Arabian Gulf
Northern Corridor	Arabian Gulf ↔ Europe



- The **India–Middle East–Europe Economic Corridor (IMEC)** is a proposed transcontinental connectivity initiative designed to link India with the Arabian Gulf and Europe through integrated sea routes, railways, roads, electricity connections, digital cables and clean-hydrogen infrastructure.
- It was announced through a non-binding Memorandum of Understanding at the **G20 Leaders' Summit in New Delhi on 9 September 2023**.
- Structure: Two linked corridors: **Eastern Corridor** and **Northern Corridor**

→ LiFE—Lifestyle for Environment



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- **LiFE—Lifestyle for Environment** is an India-led global behavioural-change movement that encourages individuals and communities to adopt sustainable, nature-friendly lifestyles.
- **Announced: 1 November 2021**
- **Announcement forum: COP26, Glasgow, United Kingdom**
- **Formally launched: 20 October 2022**
- **Launch venue: Kevadia (Ekta Nagar), Gujarat, India**
- **Launched by: Prime Minister Narendra Modi and UN Secretary-General Antonio Guterres**
- **It promotes the P3—Pro-Planet People movement.**
- **It identifies 75 actions under seven themes.**
- **Global target: mobilise one billion people for pro-environment action during 2022–27.**
- **Domestic target: at least 80% of villages and urban local bodies to become environment-friendly by 2028.**

Conference of the Parties (COP)

- The Conference of the Parties (COP) serves as the primary UN forum for implementing the 2015 Paris Agreement, where 195 parties pledged to limit global warming to well below 2°C, ideally 1.5°C above pre-industrial levels.

Conference	Year	Host
COP 31	2026	Antalya, Turkiye
COP 30	2025	Belem, Brazil
COP 29	2024	Baku, Azerbaijan
COP 28	2023	Dubai, UAE
COP 27	2022	Sharm El Sheikh, Egypt
COP 26	2021	Glasgow, United Kingdom

India's Panchamrit (Five Nectar Elements) at COP 26

- Reach 500 GW non-fossil energy capacity by 2030.
- Meet 50% of energy requirements from renewables by 2030.
- Reduce total projected carbon emissions by 1 billion tonnes from 2021–2030.
- Reduce emissions intensity of GDP by 45% by 2030.
- Achieve net-zero emissions by 2070.

